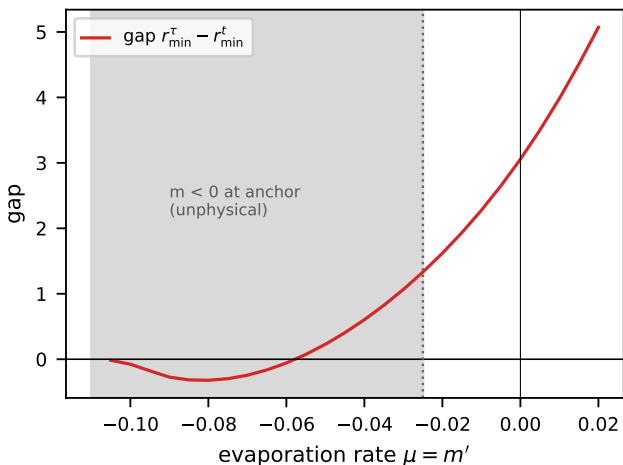


Linear $m = 1 + \mu\nu$: gap crosses 0 ONLY inside $m < 0$
 (the "inversion" is a negative-mass artifact)



Exponential $m = e^{-\lambda\nu}$ ($m > 0$ always):
 gap shrinks toward a plateau but NEVER inverts

